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W E D N E S D A Y , S E P T E M B E R 2 4 , 2 0 2 5

Moulton considers taking on Markey

Senator’s age could be factor in decision to run against him, sources say

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Representative Seth Moulton, the Democrat from Salem who has long pushed for a new generation of leaders in his party, is seriously considering a challenge to Senator Ed Markey in the 2026 primary election, according to several sources who spoke to the Globe on condition of anonymity.

If he does run, it would set up a potentially fierce battle between high-profile members of the Massachusetts congressional delegation as well as serve as a test nationally of the appetite among Democratic voters for generational change. Markey, 79, is seeking another six-year Senate term and previously served for nearly four decades in the House before moving to the upper chamber in 2013.



Seth Moulton has sought a leadership role in D.C.

According to one source familiar with Moulton’s thinking, political figures who are publicly and privately supportive of Markey have approached Moulton about running because they are concerned over Markey’s age. While Moulton has not made a final decision, the source said, the congressman is taking a serious look at entering the race.

In a statement to the Globe, Moulton said, “While I continue to look at the best options to represent Massachusetts moving forward, I have not yet made a decision about running

MOULTON, Page A7

MGB patients to pay extra when doctors consult online

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Patients at Mass General Brigham will soon be billed extra for online consultations between their doctors and specialists — a change in policy that was swiftly criticized by primary care physicians.

Primary care doctors at MGB regularly use a digital platform called eConsults to get advice on patient cases from dermatologists, neurologists, endocrinologists, and other specialists. Doctors said charging for these consultations would anger patients and could discourage physicians from contacting specialists about care.

“Patients should not need to pay for their doctors to communicate with one another,” said Dr. Michael Barnett, a primary care physician at Brigham and Women’s Hospital and professor of health policy at the Brown University School of Public Health.

But Dr. O’Neil Britton, the health system’s chief integration officer, said in an email to

CONSULT, Page A10

Parents say 5-year-old daughter used as a pawn by ICE



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

The 5-year-old was joined by her mother and her sisters.

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio and Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

A Leominster family who has lived in the United States for more than 20 years said federal immigration agents held their 5-year-old daughter, who is a US-citizen and autistic, in custody outside their home in an effort to pressure the parents to turn themselves over to agents.

In a series of videos of the incident that the family shared with the Globe, several agents with vests marked “POLICE” on them — often worn by officials from Immigration and Customs Enforcement — linger outside

the family’s home, next to the the girl.

In one of the videos, the girl is sitting on a stool in her driveway next to an SUV, surrounded by about three federal agents who towered over her, equipped with guns strapped to their bodies. The girl is wearing bright pink pants, her hair pulled back in a braid, drinking water as officers beckon her father, Edwards Hip Mejia, to come out of the house, waving him over to his driveway.

“Don’t touch her!” Hip Mejia, who is from Guatemala, yells at the agents.

“You’re more than welcome to come pick her up,” one of the

DETAIN, Page A6

‘Your countries are going to hell.’

PRESIDENT TRUMP, before the United Nations General Assembly

At UN, Trump airs his grievances



EVAN VUCCI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The president’s teleprompter malfunctioned early on, and he appeared to read his speech, with many ad-libs.

Veers on and off topic in hourlong speech; separately, shifts stance on Ukraine

By Luke Broadwater
NEW YORK TIMES

UNITED NATIONS — He accused environmentalists of wanting to “kill all the cows.” He personally insulted the Muslim mayor of London. He bashed allies and foes around the world. He questioned whether the United Nations should even exist.

“What is the purpose of the United Nations?” President Trump asked a gathering of the UN General Assembly on Tuesday, in a meandering, 56-minute speech that extended nearly four times longer than his allotted time limit.

“I’m really good at this stuff,” Trump said. “Your countries are going to hell.”

In his remarks, Trump lectured the UN and other countries about how they are failing and aired a list of grievances. That included but was not limited to: a malfunctioning escalator at the UN; his not winning a renovation contract at the UN during his time as a real estate developer; windmills; other countries’ immigration policies, which he claimed were leading them to ruin; and the way Brazil is being run.

Separately on Tuesday, Trump appeared to shift his stance on the war between Russia and Ukraine, saying he now believed Ukraine could, with military support from NATO and the United States, regain all of the territory it has lost to Russian forces.

He wrote in a social media post that Kyiv was in a position to “fight and WIN all of Ukraine back in its original form.” Trump’s change in stance came after a bilateral meeting with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, who welcomed it as a “big shift.”

His statement left many European leaders and diplomats gathered at the assembly puzzling over its meaning.

Trump said his views had been altered because he was beginning to “fully understand” the military and economic situation, and he called Russia a paper tiger with huge economic problems. He also criticized Russia for its inability to defeat its smaller neighbor on the

UNITED NATIONS, Page A5

City pays \$150,000 to pair falsely tied to Stuart case

Wu apologized to Black community in 2023

By Niki Griswold and Andrew Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

The City of Boston announced Tuesday that it paid a \$150,000 settlement to two Black men falsely identified as suspects in the 1989 Mission Hill murder of a pregnant white woman, a decades-old case that sharply divided the city along racial lines and left an indelible mark on its reputation.

The out-of-court settlement will go to two men, Willie Bennett and Alan Swanson, who were detained by Boston police and named as assailants in the supposed carjacking of Carol Stuart, who with her husband was leaving a birthing class at Brigham and Women’s Hospital. The carjacker never existed: The husband, Charles Stuart, tried to frame a fictitious

Black man to cover for the murder of his wife.

Bennett and Swanson were never charged in the case, but their lives and reputation were forever linked to it. Stuart jumped off the Tobin Bridge to his death before he could be charged.

The case received renewed attention in 2023 when the Globe published a multi-part investigation — as well as a podcast along with an associated HBO documentary series — into the Stuart case and its aftermath.

A spokesperson for Mayor Michelle Wu declined to comment Tuesday, but referred to the comments Wu made in December 2023 when she offered a public apology to Bennett, Swanson, their families, and “Boston’s entire Black com-

STUART, Page A10

The man who was charged with attempting to assassinate President Trump at a Florida golf course last year tried to stab himself with a pen shortly after being found guilty of all counts. **A2.**

Palestinians expressed doubt about the impact of recognitions of a state by several Western countries. **A3.**

An ex-coach in Rhode Island was ordered to serve a year’s probation for the naked “fat tests” he conducted on hundreds of teen athletes. **B1.**

In a time of great uncertainty in New England and across the country, people are worried most about three things — inflation, jobs, and tariffs. **The Fine Print, B5.**

With some tips, you’ll get your pick at the orchard

The author of “The Apple Lover’s Cookbook” knows where to go and what to fill up on. **G1.**



ADOBE STOCK

No sweat

Wednesday: Cloudy, cooler. High 65-70. Low 60-65.

Thursday: Showers. High 72-77. Low 64-69.

Sunrise: 6:34 Sunset: 6:38

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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